BRIAN STOKER

Experienced Lead Full Stack Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Full stack engineer and technical leader with 25+ years designing, coding, and shipping software across SaaS platforms, AAA game engines, healthcare systems, energy tech, and VR. Equally comfortable as a solo architect building a product from zero to production or leading teams of 20+ engineers through complex delivery cycles. Track record of identifying the right technology for the problem, building high-performing teams, and delivering measurable results.

CAREER ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- Solo-designed, coded, and deployed a SaaS application on AWS that yielded a $17 million valuation after 5 months
- Promoted from lead Node.js developer to Product Development Manager after completing first major project 4 months after onboarding at BMC Software
- Built a world-class 10-person backend team from the ground up by conducting 100+ interviews and selecting candidates for background, cultural fit, and drive
- Designed and implemented a real-time performance monitoring SPA serving 20+ dev teams and environments
- Improved REST API performance of a SaaS product by an average of 60% by building a monitoring tool and collaborating directly with dev teams on pain points
- Increased measurement ingestion by 3x and events by 4x through infrastructure improvements at BMC
- Expanded automation test coverage from 0% to 89.5% — the highest of any product in BMC Software's P&A Division

EXPERIENCE

Stoked Consulting — Owner / Lead Engineer

MARCH 2010 – PRESENT · AUSTIN, TX

Custom software solutions for a wide range of industries. Operates as both a solo full-stack developer and a consulting technical lead depending on client needs.

911inform.com (Consulting Client)

• Solo-designed, built, and deployed a SaaS active shooter alert system for public schools on AWS from scratch in 5 months, yielding a $17 million valuation

• Full architecture design including infrastructure, backend services, and frontend

Used Car Dealership BI Platform (Consulting Client)

• Built and maintained a custom business intelligence application for a large Houston car dealership chain

• System continuously merged various data sources into a single database with queries available via API and web/mobile UI

SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, C#, Java, Kotlin, C, C++, HLSL

Frontend: React, Angular, Next.js, MUI, Blazor

Backend: Node.js, Nest.js, Auth.js, .NET, Koa

Data: MongoDB, PostgreSQL, MSSQL, Cassandra, SQL, Entity Framework

Cloud & Infra: AWS, GCP, Terraform, CDK, SST, Ansible, Vagrant, Docker

Practices: Microservices, CI/CD, DevOps, Green/Blue Deployments, Scalability Testing, Root Cause Analysis, HIPAA Compliance

Other: ANTLR, REST APIs, WebSockets, JMeter, Selenium, Datadog, Sumo Logic, RabbitMQ, Solr

Leadership: Team Building (up to 23 direct reports), Hiring (100+ interviews), Client Consulting, Project Management, Acquisition Talent Transitioning

PROJECTS

stokd.cloud — Control plane for autonomous AI coding agents. Organizes work into Projects, Tasks, and Chores with phase-based lifecycles and falsifiable acceptance criteria. Provides real-time session monitoring, cost tracking, and orchestration tooling so engineering teams can scale AI-driven development without losing visibility.

stoked-ui.com — Open source suite of React components focused around video editing, built on the MUI framework

cenv — Open source CLI tool for managing application, infrastructure, and configuration management on AWS with CDK

AAA Games: — Silent Hill Homecoming, Age of Empires 3, GI Joe, Front Mission, Green Lantern

911 Inform — Active shooter alert system for public schools; built as SaaS from scratch for consulting client

EDUCATION

• Data generated from this system was the catalyst for major organizational shifts including product line and employee compensation restructuring

Stokd Cloud (stokd.cloud)

• Building a control plane for autonomous AI coding agents that organizes work into Projects, Tasks, and Chores with phase-based lifecycles and falsifiable acceptance criteria

• Real-time session monitoring, cost tracking, and orchestration tooling for scaling AI-driven development

Open Source / Personal Projects

• Released Stoked UI (stoked-ui.com), a suite of open source React video editing components built on MUI

• Created cenv, an open source CLI for managing application, infrastructure, and configuration management on AWS with CDK

Aristocrat Games — Sr. Software Engineer (Contract)

OCTOBER 2023 – MAY 2024 · AUSTIN, TX

• Contracted to build an intranet web application to improve knowledge sharing between game studios

• Developed a tutorial / video editing and sharing system

• Built a frontend for an internal Confluence repository using Blazor and MUI

Curb Energy — Sr. Software Engineer

FEBRUARY 2020 – APRIL 2023 · AUSTIN, TX

• Built several valuable software solutions including cenv (AWS infrastructure CLI), peak, and an energy scoring tool

Phaserlock Interactive — Sr. Software Engineer (Contract)

AUGUST 2018 – SEPTEMBER 2019 · AUSTIN, TX

• Hired as a consultant to drive development of Final Assault, a VR RTS game, to completion on Oculus and PlayStation

• Optimized HLSL shaders, gameplay systems, networking, esports-style observer mode, and customization features

• Shipped on Steam, Oculus, Vive, and PS4

BMC Software — Product Development Manager, TrueSight Intelligence / Pulse

FEBRUARY 2016 – MAY 2018 · AUSTIN, TX

Built and led a world-class team of software engineers on a SaaS machine learning product. Started as lead Node.js developer and promoted to manager after completing first major project 4 months after onboarding.

• Assembled a world-class 10-person backend Java/Kotlin team and AWS infrastructure team through extensive interviewing and prospecting; hired 4 of the top engineers nationwide

• Increased measurement ingestion by 3x and events by 4x through infrastructure improvements

• Expanded automation test coverage from 0% to 89.5%, the highest coverage rate of any product in BMC Software's P&A Division

• Designed and coded a Kotlin microservice providing a REST API with a custom query language (ANTLR 4) for user-facing search across sources and source groups

Full Sail University — Bachelor of Science, Computer Science | October 2006

Team's final project won the top prize; received an acquisition attempt on the game designed

IDesign Architecture Master Class (2011)

Project Management Training, University of Texas (2012)

• Built Node.js / Cassandra REST API responsible for handling all account management data for two BMC SaaS products

• Implemented scalability testing practice responsible for identifying and reducing ingestion bottlenecks

NextGen Healthcare — Sr. DevOps, Performance / Scalability

MARCH 2014 – JANUARY 2016 · AUSTIN, TX

Performed root cause analysis on performance issues across the entire stack; developed and executed remediation plans.

• Designed and implemented "Skybird," a single-page web app providing real-time performance and status metrics for all teams and environments. Built with Node.js, Koa, MongoDB, Angular, WebSockets, Datadog, Sumo Logic, Ansible, Vagrant, and AWS. Features included dynamic JMeter load tests launching agents into AWS, Selenium tests, aggregated per-region stats (Datadog metrics, Sumo Logic data, RabbitMQ data, Solr stats), and real-time route performance breakdowns

• Improved REST API performance of the SaaS product by an average of 60% using the monitoring tool and working directly with dev teams

• Reduced deployment time by 75% by retooling the configuration management system with Ansible and AWS

• Built Ansible roles for large enterprise application

• Implemented green/blue AWS deployment automation

NextGen Healthcare — Development Manager

JUNE 2010 – MARCH 2014 · IRVINE, CA → AUSTIN, TX

Managed the NextGen Financials team — a hospital billing solution originally built in the late 80s. Brought on just after acquisition to modernize development practices and resolve major outstanding issues.

• Managed up to 23 direct reports across all aspects of software development

• Architect and lead engineer on multiple key projects while serving as development manager

• Reduced time to post transactions by 1/6, resulting in improved data speed and fewer bottlenecks

• Stabilized support and release processes on a newly acquired hospital financial product

• Designed and implemented new development and release processes

• Primary decision maker in hiring 30+ developers, including building a new team of 10 from scratch

• Authored self-contained MEAN application for managing large VMware deployments and Vagrant

• Conducted client site visits: requirements consultation, system and solution proposal generation and delivery

Double Helix Games — Sr. Programmer

JULY 2007 – JUNE 2010 · NEWPORT BEACH, CA

Started as a gameplay developer on AAA title Silent Hill: Homecoming. After Silent Hill shipped, transitioned to the R&D and Tools team supporting three simultaneous AAA games.

• **Shipped titles:** Silent Hill Homecoming, GI Joe, Front Mission, Green Lantern

• Significantly reduced artist iteration time for texturing levels by building a custom material editor for Maya and 3ds Max pipeline tools

• Built the Maya / Max Material System supporting 12 release platforms

• Developed plugins for Maya and 3ds Max allowing designers to see levels and characters in the design environment as they would appear in-game

• Contributed to studio tools: Level Editor, Particle Editor

Big Huge Games — Programmer

NOVEMBER 2006 – JULY 2007 · TIMONIUM, MD

Entry-level game developer on Age of Empires 3.

• Succeeded in creating the first game project to come in under budget and 1 month early in studio history

• Worked on converting the PC-based render engine to run on newly released PS3 dev kits

• Prototyped Xbox 360 gameplay and 3rd-person player controls

Allied Home Mortgage — Technical Consultant

JANUARY 2004 – JANUARY 2005 · HOUSTON, TX

Lead designer and developer on the Electronic Dispersal Request System (eIDR).

• System processed $12 billion/year in mortgages across 600 branch offices nationwide — brought online for the first time

• Web services with RSA encryption

• Database design and development; integration of legacy databases

Kameleon Software — Programmer / Owner

APRIL 2002 – JANUARY 2004 · HOUSTON, TX

Took over lucrative contracts from defunct Enerva Technologies. Clients included Baylor College of Medicine, George R. Brown Convention Center, Greater Houston Convention and Visitors Bureau, and the City of Houston.

• Specialized in content management; released Kameleon Content Management .NET in early 2002

• Technical sales and solution identification for clients and prospects

Enerva Technologies — Programmer → Product Development Manager

MAY 2000 – APRIL 2002 · HOUSTON, TX

Started as entry-level web developer and rose to Product Development Manager over the company's core product, Content Speeder (CMS).

• Content management solutions: analysis, programming, documentation

• Designed and developed Content Speeder's UX

• Responsible for planning feature releases for flagship product

Infohighway Communication Corp — Web Developer

AUGUST 1999 – MAY 2000 · HOUSTON, TX

• Developed and published corporate websites using HTML, JavaScript, ColdFusion, ASP, and SQL

• Graphics creation and multimedia content

• Server administration (DNS, IIS, ColdFusion)